

CLAT Express - January 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Strike and Legal Debate

United States forces carried out a military strike on Venezuela, known as Operation Absolute Resolve. The strike targeted Caracas, Miranda, Aragua and La Guaira, and it led to the capture of Venezuelan President Nicolas Maduro. Washington justified the action by citing illegal migration, narcotics trafficking and alleged narco-terrorism. Venezuela rejected these claims, arguing that the United States was using migration and drug enforcement narratives to justify regime change. The United States presents its actions as counter-narcotics operations and national security enforcement, which it says gives a legal and political framework to its maritime actions. The action has raised a legal question: can a law enforcement objective justify the use of military force on a sovereign territory? Arguments in favour cite the claim that fentanyl and narco-gangs cause mass American deaths. Opponents warn that crime can become an excuse to violate borders. The United States designated Tren de Aragua and Cartel de los Soles as Foreign Terrorist Organisations, and Washington alleged that Cartel de los Soles operates under the leadership of Maduro. Some sections of Venezuela's domestic opposition have endorsed stronger external pressure, which indirectly supports Washington's interventionist stance. Venezuela has also strengthened partnerships with China, Russia, Iran and Cuba, which the United States views as a challenge to its strategic dominance in the Western Hemisphere. Venezuela says the intervention reflects geopolitical interests rather than genuine concern over migration or narcotics control.

Q1.

The US alleged that Venezuela's 'Cartel of the Suns' collaborated with which Colombian guerrilla group to traffic cocaine into the United States?

- (A) ELN
- (B) Sendero Luminoso
- (C) FARC
- (D) M-19

Q2.

How many core principles did the Monroe Doctrine have?

- (A) One
- (B) Two
- (C) Four
- (D) Three

Q3.

Which of the following statements about the Monroe Doctrine and related policy is/are correct?

- I. The Monroe Doctrine was proclaimed in 1823.
- II. The Roosevelt Corollary expanded the Monroe Doctrine to justify US intervention to maintain stability in the Western Hemisphere.
- III. The Monroe Doctrine was originally designed to encourage European colonisation of the Americas.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Monroe Doctrine	A. January 2019
II. Roosevelt Corollary	B. Articles 233 and 333
III. Maduro's second term	C. 1904
IV. Juan Guaido's declaration	D. 1823

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Venezuela has the world's largest proven crude oil reserves, estimated at over how many billion barrels?

- (A) 100
- (B) 200
- (C) 300
- (D) 400

Q6.

Assertion (A): The Roosevelt Corollary of 1904 allowed European powers to intervene in the Western Hemisphere to maintain stability.

Reason (R): The Monroe Doctrine was expanded through the Roosevelt Corollary to justify US intervention in the Western Hemisphere.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the UN Security Council and related interventions:

- I. The P5 members of the UN Security Council are the US, Russia, China, the UK and France.
- II. Between 2015 and 2024, 47 vetoes blocked 37 draft resolutions.
- III. NATO, AU and ECOWAS intervene only with UNSC approval.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q8.

What position did Juan Guaido hold when he declared himself Acting President?

- (A) Head of National Assembly
- (B) Vice President
- (C) Governor of Caracas
- (D) Minister of Foreign Affairs

Greenland's Status: Practice Set

Greenland is the world's largest island and forms one of Denmark's two autonomous territories, the other being the Faroe Islands. Its relationship with Denmark has a long history. The island became

a Danish colony in the early eighteenth century, after an expedition led by the Danish-Norwegian missionary Hans Egede arrived in 1721. It became a self-governing territory in 1979, and since 2009 it has held the right to declare independence through a referendum. The island's status is now at the centre of a fresh dispute. Denmark's Prime Minister, Mette Frederiksen, has rejected United States claims on Greenland and reaffirmed Danish sovereignty over the Arctic territory. Greenland's place in wider alliances is shaped by Denmark's membership of NATO. Since Denmark is part of the alliance, Greenland is by default part of it as well. Greenland is not a member state of the European Union, but it is associated with the Union as one of the EU Overseas Countries and Territories. As a result, Greenlanders are considered to be EU citizens. Together, its autonomy, its right to independence and its alliance links explain why the island matters to Denmark, Europe and the United States.

Q1.

Which island in Greenland is recognised as the world's northernmost point of land?

- (A) Ellesmere Island
- (B) Nord Island
- (C) Alert Island
- (D) Kaffeklubben Island

Q2.

Assertion (A): Greenland gives the North Atlantic a strategic role in monitoring naval movements.

Reason (R): The GIUK Gap is named after Greenland, Ireland and the United Kingdom.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pituffik Space Base	A. Crucial for semiconductors, renewable energy and defence systems
II. US proposal of 1946	B. Formerly known as Thule Air Base
III. 1951 agreement	C. Offer of \$100 million to Denmark for outright purchase
IV. Rare earth elements	D. US-Denmark Defence Agreement on military access

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

I. Russia has heavily militarised the Arctic coastline.

II. China labels itself a Near-Arctic State.

III. The United States proposed to buy Greenland from Denmark in 1951.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Greenland and the EU:

- I. Greenland joined the European Community together with Denmark in 1973 but left in 1985.
- II. The Anti-Coercion Instrument was designed mainly as a tool for direct military retaliation.
- III. The Transpolar Sea Route is one of the emerging Arctic shipping routes linked to melting ice.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

What name does the booklet give to the EU's Anti-Coercion Instrument?

- (A) Trade Bazooka
- (B) Economic Shield
- (C) Strategic Hammer
- (D) Coercion Wall

Q7.

Which body takes decisions to invite a country to join NATO?

- (A) European Commission
- (B) United Nations Security Council
- (C) North Atlantic Council
- (D) Arctic Council

Q8.

Statement I: Under Article 5, an armed attack on one NATO Ally is treated as an attack on all members.

Statement II: NATO was created by 12 countries on 4 April 1949.

Which of the statements is/are correct?

- (A) Only I
- (B) Only II
- (C) Neither I nor II
- (D) Both I and II

Board of Peace: structure and purpose

The United States has begun the process of forming a new body called the Board of Peace, which is intended to play a part in the future of Gaza. The Board is described as an inter-governmental body led by the United States. It is envisioned as a new international body with a transitional governance role for Gaza after the current conflict. Its design combines elements of international oversight, political coordination and developmental administration. Its proposed mandate includes supervising and guiding the civil administration of Gaza and its security and stabilisation force, mobilising international financial and technical assistance, and ensuring transparency, coordination and accountability during Gaza's transition from conflict to reconstruction. The Board is governed by a charter, which sets out rules on membership, financial contributions and the settlement of disputes. A separate group of global leaders and international figures also supports the arrangement. The arrangement is closely tied to the 20-point peace plan proposed by the United States for ending the war in Gaza. Beyond Gaza, the Board is being presented as a possible template for managing complex global conflicts. Its approach marks a move away from traditional universal multilateral institutions. Such a move raises questions about how institutions like the United Nations should respond to fragmented peacebuilding efforts. Such initiatives are presented as working within existing structures rather than replacing them.

Q1.

Under which UN Security Council resolution was the Board of Peace established?

- (A) Resolution 184 (1947)
- (B) Resolution 1373 (2001)
- (C) Resolution 2803 (2025)
- (D) Resolution 242 (1967)

Q2.

How many Articles does the charter of the Board of Peace contain?

- (A) Seven
- (B) Four
- (C) 20
- (D) 13

Q3.

In which circumstance can the chairman of the Board of Peace be removed?

- (A) If the UN General Assembly votes to remove him
- (B) If two-thirds of member countries request it
- (C) If the US Congress approves it
- (D) Only if he resigns voluntarily or is unanimously declared incapable by the Executive Board

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. High Representative for Gaza	A. 13 Articles
II. Chairman of the NCAG	B. 31 December 2027
III. Initial authorisation of the Board ends	C. Nickolay Mladenov
IV. Number of Articles in the charter	D. Ali Shaath

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Board of Peace:

- I. It is a US-led inter-governmental body established under a UN Security Council resolution.
- II. Its chairman is the US Secretary of State.
- III. Its charter contains 13 Articles.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Gaza plan:

1. All hostages, alive or deceased, must be released within 72 hours of Israel's acceptance of the plan.
2. Hamas members who decommission weapons can receive amnesty or safe passage abroad.
3. Israel is to occupy Gaza permanently under the plan.
4. The plan proposes a special economic zone in Gaza.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

1. A country that joins the Board of Peace must consent to be bound by its charter.
2. The Gaza Executive Board includes a Palestinian representative.

Which statement is correct?

- (A) Only statement 1 is correct
- (B) Only statement 2 is correct
- (C) Both statements are correct
- (D) Neither statement is correct

Chagos Dispute Check

The Chagos Islands have been at the centre of a long dispute between Britain and Mauritius. Before Mauritius became independent, Britain set up the islands as a separate territory, and they stayed under British control after independence. In that period, native Chagossians were forcibly removed from their homes so that a military base could be built on Diego Garcia, the largest island in the archipelago. Mauritius responded through international legal channels. It took the matter to the Permanent Court of Arbitration in The Hague, which found that Britain had violated Mauritius' rights under a major international maritime convention. The ruling also stressed that defence interests had been given priority over Mauritius' rights, and it described Britain's actions as a violation of good faith. Britain, however, insisted that the issue should remain a bilateral matter between the two countries. Mauritius then turned to the United Nations, where the General Assembly voted on a resolution seeking an advisory opinion from the International Court of Justice. The Court later ordered Britain to return the islands to Mauritius. Britain argued that the Court had no jurisdiction over the matter. The dispute reflects a tension between international legal norms on decolonisation and security interests in the Indian Ocean.

Q1.

In which year did the UK declare the Chagos Islands a British Indian Ocean Territory?

- (A) 1960
- (B) 1970
- (C) 1968
- (D) 1965

Q2.

Between which years were native Chagossians forcibly removed from the islands?

- (A) 1960-1965
- (B) 1965-1970
- (C) 1968-1973
- (D) 1970-1975

Q3.

Under which convention did the Permanent Court of Arbitration rule that the UK had violated Mauritius' rights?

- (A) Geneva Convention
- (B) Vienna Convention
- (C) UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS)
- (D) Rome Statute

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Marine Protected Area created around the Chagos Islands	A. 2015
II. Mauritius initiated legal proceedings at the Permanent Court of Arbitration	B. 2017
III. UNGA voted on Mauritius' resolution seeking an ICJ advisory opinion	C. 2019
IV. ICJ ordered the UK to return the Chagos Islands to Mauritius	D. 2010

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UK declared the Chagos Islands a British Indian Ocean Territory in 1965.
- II. Mauritius gained independence from Britain in 1966.
- III. The ICJ ordered the UK to return the Chagos Islands to Mauritius in 2019.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UK and the US forcibly removed native Chagossians from the islands.
- II. The UN General Assembly voted on Mauritius' resolution in 2015.
- III. The Court found that the UK had ulterior motives in creating a Marine Protected Area around the Chagos Islands.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

In which year did the UN General Assembly vote on Mauritius' resolution to seek an ICJ advisory opinion?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2017

UAE-Saudi rift: practice set

Relations between Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates have come under strain over Yemen, where both countries belong to the anti-Houthi coalition. Saudi military aircraft carried out airstrikes on Mukalla Port in southern Yemen after a consignment arrived from Fujairah in the UAE. Riyadh alleged that the cargo contained arms meant for southern separatist groups. Abu Dhabi rejected this, stating that the shipment consisted of vehicles meant exclusively for UAE forces. Saudi aircraft also struck units of the UAE-supported Southern Transitional Council (STC), with strikes reported in the Hadramout region. The action followed an attempt by Saudi-aligned National Shield Forces to take control of STC military installations, a move the STC strongly opposed. Riyadh then called for STC fighters to withdraw from contested areas, but the group refused. The standoff intensified amid the STC's recent expansion into Hadramout and Mahra, provinces that border Saudi Arabia. Saudi officials described the airstrikes as a preventive and limited intervention meant to avert wider instability. The two governments gave different accounts of the episode. The UAE responded by pulling its troops out of Saudi Arabia. The episode exposes fault lines between two states that share opposition to the Iran-backed Houthi movement, and it complicates prospects for a unified peace process in Yemen.

Q1.

Who became the President of the unified Republic of Yemen in 1990?

- (A) Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi
- (B) Rashad al-Alimi
- (C) Hussein al-Houthi
- (D) Ali Abdullah Saleh

Q2.

Which city is Yemen's capital, currently under Houthi control?

- (A) Aden
- (B) Mukalla
- (C) Hodeidah
- (D) Sanaa

Q3.

According to the UAE, its military presence in Yemen is confined to which activity?

- (A) Nation building
- (B) Political mediation
- (C) Counter-terrorism operations
- (D) Humanitarian assistance

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Southern Transitional Council	A. Captured territory in southern and eastern Yemen at various points
II. Southern Movement (Al-Hirak)	B. Originated among the Zaydi Shia population of northern Yemen
III. Houthi movement	C. Formed in 2007
IV. Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula	D. Advocates autonomy or independence for southern Yemen since 2017

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Until 1990, Yemen existed as two separate countries.
- II. The two Yemeni states merged in 1994 to form the Republic of Yemen.
- III. Ali Abdullah Saleh had governed North Yemen since 1978.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Saudi Arabia asked the UAE to withdraw its military elements from Yemen within 24 hours.
- II. The UAE described its military presence in Yemen as aimed at political mediation.
- III. The Houthis control the north and west of Yemen.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Ansar Allah is the official name of which Yemeni movement?

- (A) Southern Transitional Council
- (B) Southern Movement (Al-Hirak)
- (C) Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula
- (D) Houthi movement

Republic Day Chronology and History

India celebrates Republic Day on 26 January every year to honour the adoption of its Constitution in 1950, which established a sovereign democratic republic. The festivities officially begin on 23 January, observed as Parakram Divas in honour of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. On the day before Republic Day, the President of India delivers the Republic Day Address to the nation. Early on 26 January, the Prime Minister pays homage at the Amar Jawan Jyoti. The President then unfurls the National Flag at Kartavya Path, formerly known as Rajpath,

followed by the National Anthem and a 21-gun salute that marks the formal start of the parade. In the evening, the President confers the Padma and Gallantry Awards. The celebrations conclude on 29 January at Vijay Chowk with the Beating Retreat Ceremony. The history of the day goes back to the Lahore Session of the Indian National Congress in December 1929, which passed the Poorna Swaraj resolution calling for complete independence from British rule. From 1930 to 1947, 26 January was celebrated as Independence Day or Poorna Swaraj Day. India gained independence on 15 August 1947, which led to a re-evaluation of the significance of Republic Day. The Constitution came into effect on 26 January 1950, ending India's status as a Dominion of the British Crown.

Q1.

Who were the Chief Guests for India's Republic Day 2026?

- (A) Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa
- (B) President of the United States and Prime Minister of Japan
- (C) Prime Minister of Japan and President of France
- (D) King of Nepal and Queen Elizabeth II

Q2.

How many honours were conferred under the Padma Awards 2026?

- (A) 131
- (B) 113
- (C) 12
- (D) 70

Q3.

Which award was conferred on Shubhanshu Shukla, the first Indian on the ISS?

- (A) Padma Vibhushan
- (B) Ashok Chakra
- (C) Kirti Chakra
- (D) Bharat Ratna

Q4.

Assertion (A): Gallantry Awards are announced twice a year, on Republic Day and Independence Day.

Reason (R): Wartime Gallantry was instituted on 26 January 1950.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Parakram Divas	A. 29 January
II. Beating Retreat Ceremony	B. 26 November
III. Constitution Day	C. 26 January
IV. Amar Jawan Jyoti homage	D. 23 January

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

- I. Padma Awards are announced annually on the eve of Republic Day.
- II. Wartime Gallantry awards were instituted before Peacetime Gallantry awards.
- III. Gallantry Awards are announced only once a year, on Republic Day.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) II only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The 2026 Chief Guests were Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa.
- II. Constitution Day is observed on 26 November.
- III. The Prime Minister unfurls the National Flag on Republic Day.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

On which date was the Declaration of Independence officially promulgated?

- (A) 26 January 1930
- (B) 15 August 1947
- (C) 26 November 1949
- (D) 26 January 1950

Equity Regulations: Provisions and Checks

The University Grants Commission notified the Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions Regulations, 2026 to promote equity, inclusion and anti-discrimination in Indian higher education institutions. The regulations define caste-based discrimination broadly, to include unfair or biased treatment, and cover direct, indirect and systemic discrimination. Their objectives also include preventing discrimination on campuses based on religion, gender, race, disability or place of birth. The central mechanism is the Equal Opportunity Centre, a nodal body for promoting equity and inclusion on campus. Each centre has an Equity Committee that receives and inquires into complaints. The committee includes faculty, non-teaching staff, civil society members and students, with the centre's coordinator acting as member secretary. The committee must convene quickly after a complaint is received and must submit its report within a set number of working days. Unresolved grievances can be appealed to an independent Ombudsperson, whose decisions bind institutions. Accountability is built into the framework. Centres submit bi-annual reports, institutions submit annual equity compliance reports, and a National Monitoring Committee oversees compliance. Heads of institutions are held responsible for compliance, and non-compliance can lead to debarment from UGC schemes, restrictions on offering degrees, or withdrawal of UGC recognition. The framework therefore links every institution to a formal reporting and oversight chain.

Q1.

How many working days are allowed for the Equity Committee to complete its inquiry and submit its report?

- (A) 10 working days
- (B) 12 working days
- (C) 15 working days
- (D) 30 working days

Q2.

How many senior faculty members sit on the Equity Committee as other members?

- (A) 3
- (B) 1
- (C) 2
- (D) 4

Q3.

Which groups does the representation requirement for the Equity Committee cover?

- (A) Only students and faculty members
- (B) Only SC and ST communities
- (C) Only women and students
- (D) SC, ST, OBC, women and persons with disabilities

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Equity Committee must convene within 24 hours of receiving a complaint.

Reason (R): The Head of the institution serves as Chairperson of the Equity Committee.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Convening of Equity Committee after a complaint	A. Two
II. Submission of Equity Committee inquiry report	B. At least twice a year
III. Student representatives on the Equity Committee	C. Within 24 hours
IV. National Monitoring Committee meetings	D. 15 working days

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the 2026 Regulations:

- I. Equal Opportunity Centres are mandatory in all higher education institutions.
- II. The decisions of the Ombudsperson are not binding on institutions.
- III. Institutions submit an annual equity compliance report to UGC.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Equal Opportunity Centres act as a nodal body for promoting equity and inclusion on campus.
- II. The Ombudsperson is a part of the Equity Committee.
- III. Heads of institutions are held responsible for compliance.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Equity Committee's inquiry must be completed within 30 working days.
- II. The National Monitoring Committee meets once every year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Incubation Schemes Check

Support for new businesses in India is organised through several government programmes, and each one has a specific focus. Some programmes provide physical infrastructure to young firms through incubation centres, along with support to help them grow. Other programmes are designed for cities beyond the largest metropolitan areas, where the aim is to open opportunities for entrepreneurs outside major centres. A further group focuses on particular fields, including emerging technologies that are expected to shape future industries. Rural industries and agro-based enterprises are also covered by some schemes. Several of these programmes connect startups with mentors and networks, which helps founders gain practical guidance. Programmes differ in how they are delivered: some work through physical centres, some through online platforms and some through funding or guarantees. Together these programmes show that innovation is meant to spread widely rather than remain confined to a few cities or sectors. Students should note that every programme has a distinct purpose, a target group and a full name that explains its work. Knowing the expansion of each acronym, and the place or sector each one serves, is essential for answering precise questions on this topic. Read each scheme with its objective and its region of focus in mind.

Q1.

What does GENESIS stand for?

- (A) Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups
- (B) Gen-Next Support for Innovation Startups
- (C) Generation Support for Innovative Startups
- (D) Gen-Next System for Innovative Startups

Q2.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Atal Innovation Mission establishes Atal Incubation Centres.
- II. GENESIS focuses on startups in metropolitan cities.
- III. NIDHI aims at socio-economic growth through wealth and job creation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q3.

Under which body does the Atal Innovation Mission operate?

- (A) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- (B) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (C) NITI Aayog
- (D) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Q4.

Which scheme sets up a network of technology centres and incubation centres to promote agro-industry startups?

- (A) ASPIRE
- (B) GENESIS
- (C) NIDHI
- (D) TIDE 2.0

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. GENESIS	A. Technology-driven ideas into successful startups
II. ASPIRE	B. Startups in Tier-II and Tier-III cities
III. NIDHI	C. Startups in AI, IoT and Blockchain
IV. TIDE 2.0	D. Network of technology and incubation centres for agro-industry

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. TIDE 2.0 supports startups in emerging technologies such as AI, IoT and Blockchain.
- II. GENESIS was launched in 2016.
- III. ASPIRE stands for A Scheme for Promotion of Innovation, Rural Industries and Entrepreneurship.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Which scheme aims at socio-economic growth through wealth and job creation?

- (A) ASPIRE
- (B) TIDE 2.0
- (C) GENESIS
- (D) NIDHI

India-EU FTA: CLAT Practice

India and the European Union have concluded a free trade agreement that is widely described as a landmark in their economic relationship. The deal was finalised at the 16th India-EU Summit held in New Delhi, and it is expected to create an economic space covering around two billion people. It brings to a close a long series of talks that began in 2007, were suspended for a period, and were later revived. Before the deal can be fully implemented, it still needs to be ratified by the Indian Parliament and by European bodies.

The agreement is also a response to a changing global trade environment. Supply chain disruptions and rising protectionism have pushed India to diversify its trade partnerships, and the deal is seen as a way to reduce dependence on a single market. Both sides have kept comprehensive negative lists for sensitive farm commodities, so that rural livelihoods and food security are protected. A parallel agreement on geographical indications is meant to stop the unauthorised use of iconic products in either market.

The European Union itself is a political and economic union of member states. Its institutions include an executive body that proposes laws and manages the budget, a legislature that shares lawmaking duties, a council of heads of state or government, and a court that ensures EU law is applied uniformly. The EU has also introduced a carbon levy on certain imports, a measure that India views with concern as a possible form of green protectionism.

Q1.

What was the total bilateral trade between India and the EU in 2024-25?

- (A) \$126.53 billion
- (B) \$130.53 billion
- (C) \$136.53 billion
- (D) \$146.53 billion

Q2.

Consider the following:

Assertion (A): Indian labour-intensive exporters are expected to gain significantly in the EU market.

Reason (R): The EU will eliminate customs duties on 99.5% of Indian exports, and labour-intensive goods such as textiles now enter the EU at 0% duty.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. EU duty elimination on Indian exports	A. 110%
II. Pre-reduction tariff on cars above EUR 15,000	B. 250,000 units
III. Annual tariff rate quota for these cars	C. 44%
IV. Maximum current Indian tariff on machinery	D. 99.5%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the India-EU FTA:

- I. India will phase out tariffs on over 90% of EU goods.
- II. Dairy, wheat, rice and poultry are inside India's tariff reduction framework.
- III. The EU has exempted beef, sugar and rice from its own tariff cuts.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM):

- I. The transitional phase from 2023 to 2025 carried no financial levy.
- II. Textiles and apparel are among the sectors covered by CBAM.
- III. Importers must buy CBAM certificates linked to the embedded carbon in goods.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

How many Commissioners does the European Commission have?

- (A) 27
- (B) 26
- (C) 28
- (D) 25

Q7.

Which EU institution is the only elected legislative body?

- (A) European Council
- (B) European Parliament
- (C) Court of Justice of the EU
- (D) European Central Bank

Q8.

From what date does the full CBAM carbon levy on imports apply?

- (A) 1 January 2025
- (B) 1 July 2026
- (C) 1 January 2027
- (D) 1 January 2026

Birth Control Policy in China

China's approach to family size has changed several times since the Mao era. In the early phase, birth control existed under Mao Zedong, but it was not a major policy priority. Later, the government's five-year plans began promoting birth control, and in some cases the measures used were coercive. A strict limit on family size was then introduced, and this limit was relaxed in stages over the following decades. The relaxation did not bring fertility back to earlier levels. Women now have higher education and employment, which has enhanced their autonomy over reproductive decisions and contributed to delayed childbirth. Changing social attitudes, economic pressures and high urban living costs and housing pressures are also among the factors linked to the trend. Many young people delay marriage and childbirth because of job competition and work-life stress. Economic and social barriers also prevent many couples from having the number of children they desire. Smaller families, in turn, can disrupt traditional support systems for the elderly. The COVID-19 pandemic further accelerated the decline. Overall, the experience shows how policy changes alone may not reverse deep-rooted behavioural patterns in a population.

Q1.

In which years did the Great Leap Forward occur in China?

- (A) 1958-1962
- (B) 1955-1960
- (C) 1960-1965
- (D) 1962-1967

Q2.

Which slogan was promoted in China's birth control push of the 1970s?

- (A) Small Family, Happy Family
- (B) One Child, One Nation
- (C) Later, Longer, Fewer
- (D) Quality over Quantity

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Great Leap Forward (1958-62)	A. Slogan encouraging delayed marriage and births
II. Later, Longer, Fewer	B. Further relaxation of birth limits
III. One-Child Policy (1980)	C. Famine and millions of deaths
IV. Three-Child Policy (2021)	D. Restricted most couples to a single child

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q4.

- I. China's total fertility rate was 1.3 births per woman in the 2020 Census.
- II. Population growth rebounded after the Great Leap Forward was rolled back.
- III. China's Three-Child Policy was introduced in 2016.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q5.

How many of the following statements about China's population policy are correct?

- I. The slogan 'Later, Longer, Fewer' encouraged longer intervals between births.
- II. The One-Child Policy was formally introduced in 1975.
- III. China's TFR was 2.75 in 1979.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

- I. The Great Leap Forward aimed to boost production and living standards.
- II. Population growth rebounded during the Great Leap Forward.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

BBNJ and the law of the seas

The world's oceans are divided into zones with very different legal status. Near a coast, a state has full sovereignty over its territorial sea, and its exclusive economic zone gives it the right to exploit economic resources. Further out lie spaces that belong to no single country. These spaces, known as areas beyond national jurisdiction, cover the high seas and the international seabed area. They are described as global commons and are open to all states for activities such as navigation, overflight and the laying of submarine cables and pipelines. Taken together, these areas make up a large share of the world's ocean surface, so their governance is a serious concern. The main legal framework for all ocean activities is the 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea, often called the constitution for the oceans. Within that framework, a newer treaty was negotiated

to protect biodiversity in areas beyond national jurisdiction. Its negotiations took place under a United Nations conference devoted to marine biodiversity in these areas. The new treaty is significant because it is the first global legal framework of its kind for protecting ocean biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction. It sits alongside the 1994 agreement on deep seabed mining and the 1995 UN Fish Stocks Agreement as part of the Convention's framework. Its goals also support wider global commitments on nature conservation, so it is closely tied to international biodiversity efforts.

Q1.

How many countries have ratified the BBNJ Agreement?

- (A) 63
- (B) 73
- (C) 83
- (D) 93

Q2.

What is India's status regarding the BBNJ Agreement?

- (A) Signed, ratification pending
- (B) Ratified
- (C) Not signed
- (D) Rejected

Q3.

Assertion (A): Coastal states have full sovereignty over the high seas.

Reason (R): The high seas are free for navigation by vessels of all nations.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. BBNJ Agreement adopted	A. 30%
II. Countries that have ratified BBNJ	B. 2023
III. Land and sea protection target by 2030	C. 4
IV. Number of pillars of BBNJ	D. 83

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the BBNJ Agreement:

- I. It was adopted in 2023.
- II. India has ratified it.
- III. The Conference of the Parties is its decision-making body.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the BBNJ Agreement are correct?

- I. It was adopted in 2023.
- II. It has been ratified by 83 countries.
- III. It has five pillars.
- IV. India has ratified it.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT one of the four pillars of the BBNJ Agreement?

- (A) Marine Genetic Resources
- (B) Environmental Impact Assessments
- (C) Capacity Building and Technology Transfer
- (D) Climate Change Mitigation

Q8.

Which target is mentioned for the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework that the BBNJ Agreement supports?

- (A) 30% of land and sea by 2030
- (B) 20% of land and sea by 2025
- (C) 40% of land and sea by 2035
- (D) 50% of land and sea by 2040

PSLV-C62 mission check

ISRO planned its first launch of 2026 with PSLV-C62, a rocket scheduled to lift off from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh. The Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle is often called the workhorse of ISRO, and this flight carried a mix of government and commercial satellites. During the mission, a fault appeared in the third stage. A solid rocket anomaly disrupted the high-thrust delivery to the upper stages, and this affected the planned injection of the satellites into orbit. The failure came after an earlier setback with PSLV-C61, which put the vehicle under close scrutiny.

Among the payloads was EOS-N1, also known as Anvesha, an Earth observation satellite built for strategic applications. Another payload was KID, a small re-entry prototype developed by a Spanish startup, which was meant to splash down in the ocean. The flight also carried AayulSAT, a satellite refuelling payload from a Bengaluru company, and a group of co-passenger satellites from several countries. Together, the payloads covered Earth observation, re-entry testing and satellite refuelling. Each payload was carried on the same rocket, so a fault in the upper stages put all of them at risk. The rocket's earlier flights, including missions to the Moon and Mars, show why its reliability matters for the national programme.

Q1.

How many months passed between the PSLV-C61 setback and the PSLV-C62 failure? (in months)

- (A) 6 months
- (B) 8 months
- (C) 10 months
- (D) 12 months

Q2.

Which organisation developed the EOS-N1 (Anvesha) satellite?

- (A) ISRO
- (B) HAL
- (C) DRDO
- (D) BARC

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Anvesha (EOS-N1)	A. First on-orbit satellite refuelling payload
II. Kestrel Initial Demonstrator	B. Liquid propellant second stage of PSLV
III. AayulSAT	C. Small-scale re-entry vehicle prototype
IV. Vikas engine	D. Hyperspectral imaging satellite

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q4.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- I. PSLV was first launched in 1993.
- II. PSLV uses liquid propellants in its first and third stages.
- III. PSLV can carry up to 1750 kg to a 600 km Sun-synchronous orbit.

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about PSLV-C62 and its payloads are correct?

- A. The launch was scheduled from Sriharikota.
- B. The KID prototype was developed in India.
- C. A total of 104 satellites flew on PSLV-C62.
- D. AayulSAT was developed by a Bengaluru-based company.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6.

Which PSLV flight carried Aditya-L1 into space?

- (A) PSLV-C57
- (B) PSLV-C58
- (C) PSLV-C62
- (D) PSLV-C61

Q7.

Which Bengaluru-based company developed AayulSAT?

- (A) Agnikul Cosmos
- (B) Skyroot Aerospace
- (C) Pixxel Space
- (D) OrbitAID Aerospace

Governance Act practice set

The National Sports Governance Act and its rules mark a major change in how sports are run in India. The key institutional mechanisms came into force in January 2026, after the Union Government notified the National Sports Governance (National Sports Bodies) Rules, 2026. The reforms aim to make sports administration more transparent, inclusive and accountable. At the centre of the system is an apex regulatory body that decides which national sports bodies remain recognised, and it keeps a central register of those bodies. Elections in sports federations will be overseen by a panel drawn from experienced former election officials, so that long-standing problems of conflict of interest and factionalism can be addressed. Disputes about athlete selection, elections and governance will go to a separate tribunal, which is meant to resolve cases independently, speedily and at a reasonable cost. Doping-related matters follow a different legal route. Every national sports body must also have a general body and an executive committee; the general body must include sportspersons and the executive committee must include women. The reforms are meant to curb politicisation, arbitrary decisions and the lack of accountability in sports administration. Beyond governance, the government runs programmes that encourage fitness, identify young talent and support athletes who aim to win medals at the Olympics.

Q1.

Assertion (A): Appeals against National Sports Tribunal decisions lie only before the Supreme Court.

Reason (R): The National Sports Tribunal is headed by a sitting or retired Supreme Court Judge or Chief Justice of a High Court.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National Olympic Committee	A. Established in 2005
II. National Paralympic Committee	B. Sole governing body for Olympic sports in India
III. Court of Arbitration for Sport	C. Sole governing body for Paralympic sports
IV. National Anti-Doping Agency	D. Established in 1984 by the IOC

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Sports Election Panel must have at least 20 members at all times.
- II. Recognised sports bodies are deemed public authorities under the RTI Act 2005.
- III. The appellate authority for National Sports Tribunal decisions is the High Court.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Search-cum-Selection Committee of the National Sports Board:

- I. It is chaired by the Cabinet Secretary.
- II. It includes two recipients of National Sports Awards.
- III. It includes the Secretary of the Ministry of Finance.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q5.

What is the minimum number of Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit required in the General Body of every National Sports Body?

- (A) 2
- (B) 6
- (C) 4
- (D) 8

Q6.

In which year was the National Anti-Doping Agency set up?

- (A) 2001
- (B) 2008
- (C) 2014
- (D) 2005

Q7.

Who is the youngest Indian to win an individual Olympic medal?

- (A) Manu Bhaker
- (B) Aman Sehrawat
- (C) Praveen Kumar
- (D) D Gukesh

Q8.

How many other members besides the head does the National Sports Tribunal have?

- (A) 2
- (B) 1
- (C) 3
- (D) 4

UN and Control Regimes Check

The United Nations Security Council is one of the six principal organs of the United Nations and was established in 1945 under the UN Charter. Its main purpose is maintaining international peace

and security. It addresses countries that threaten global security, authorises peacekeeping missions and imposes sanctions. In cases of international conflict, it can also authorise the use of force. The Council has fifteen members. Five of them are permanent members: China, France, Russia, the United States and the United Kingdom. The other ten are non-permanent members, and the General Assembly elects five of them each year for a two-year term. These ten seats are distributed on a regional basis. The Council's headquarters are in New York City. Several arrangements outside the Council work to limit the spread of dangerous weapons. The Australia Group was founded in 1985 in response to the use of chemical weapons during the Iran-Iraq War, and it works to prevent the proliferation of chemical and biological weapons. Three export control regimes also operate in this field: the Nuclear Suppliers Group, the Missile Technology Control Regime and the Wassenaar Arrangement. Each of these bodies is a separate arrangement with its own membership and purpose. The booklet presents these as part of the wider international effort against weapons proliferation.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty was extended indefinitely in 1995.
- II. North Korea remains a member of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) Neither I nor II
- (B) I only
- (C) II only
- (D) Both I and II

Q2.

- I. The Missile Technology Control Regime was set up in 1987 to prevent the spread of missile and drone technology.
- II. The Australia Group has 42 member countries along with the European Union.
- III. The Wassenaar Arrangement was set up before the Missile Technology Control Regime.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

Assertion (A): The guidelines of the Australia Group are legally binding on all its members.

Reason (R): The Australia Group is an informal multilateral arrangement and is not legally binding.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (C) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q4.

How many of the following statements about the UN Security Council are correct?

- I. The Council's presidency rotates among its 15 members every month.
- II. The Security Council itself elects the five non-permanent members each year.
- III. India served as a non-permanent member seven times before its 2021-22 term.
- IV. Germany is one of the prime movers of the Coffee Club.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Nuclear Suppliers Group	A. Controls conventional arms and dual-use goods
II. Missile Technology Control Regime	B. Classifies states by nuclear status as of 1 January 1967
III. Wassenaar Arrangement	C. Prevents spread of missile and drone technology
IV. Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty	D. Regulates nuclear-related exports

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

In which year did India join the Australia Group?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 1996
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2021

Q7.

Which country is one of the prime movers of the Coffee Club, a group that opposes expansion of permanent seats on the UNSC?

- (A) Brazil
- (B) Japan
- (C) Germany
- (D) Italy

Q8.

In which year was the Wassenaar Arrangement established?

- (A) 1996
- (B) 1975
- (C) 1987
- (D) 1985

Type-in-the-answer passages

Crisis and Sanctions Recall

Venezuela is located on the northern coast of South America and is bordered by Colombia, Brazil, Guyana and the Atlantic Ocean. The country's official language is Spanish, and its economy has depended heavily on oil revenue. Venezuela has been facing a deep political and economic collapse for several years. Hyperinflation, prolonged power outages, food shortages and a breakdown of healthcare services have caused severe humanitarian distress. The crisis escalated when Juan Guaido, the head of the National Assembly, declared himself Acting President. His claim directly challenged President Nicolas Maduro. Under Maduro's leadership, Venezuela's economy suffered a drastic contraction, which is largely blamed on corruption, poor governance and overdependence on oil. Presidential elections were widely criticised as unfair and non-transparent, and opposition leaders were barred, imprisoned or exiled. The opposition-controlled National Assembly rejected the legitimacy of the election results. Guaido's declaration as interim president gained international recognition from several Western countries, while nations like Russia and China continued supporting Maduro. Many Venezuelans have left the country, mainly for other Latin American countries, to escape these conditions. US sanctions drastically limited Venezuela's oil

exports to the United States, forcing Caracas to seek alternative buyers. Caracas has rejected all allegations and has argued that the United States is weaponising migration and drug enforcement narratives to justify regime change. Venezuela maintains that the intervention reflects geopolitical interests rather than genuine concern.

Q1.

Which state-owned oil firm did Washington target with comprehensive sanctions? (one word or acronym)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year were Venezuela's presidential elections widely criticised as unfair and non-transparent?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of Venezuela's currency? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term did the opposition-controlled National Assembly use to describe Maduro? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was Nicolas Maduro sworn in for his controversial second term?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Monroe Doctrine proclaimed? (year)

Answer: _____

Minerals and Arctic Routes: Typed Answers

Climate change is reshaping the Arctic. Melting sea ice is opening new maritime corridors through waters that were once difficult to navigate. Shipping along these corridors could shorten travel times between the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, while lowering fuel and shipping costs. The new routes could also allow ships to avoid some of the chokepoints that currently shape global trade. Control over these sea lanes is expected to influence future trade flows and the projection of naval power. Greenland's own resources add to the region's importance. The island holds mineral wealth that is vital for semiconductors, renewable energy equipment and defence systems. Many Western economies see new sources of these minerals as a way to diversify supply chains that are heavily concentrated elsewhere. This push forms part of a wider effort to decouple sensitive economic sectors from rival suppliers. China is also investing in Arctic research and infrastructure, which signals long-term interest in the region. Taken together, the changing Arctic is becoming a centre of economic and strategic competition, and the outcome will shape which countries gain leverage over future trade.

Q1.

Which country currently dominates the rare earth elements market? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which emerging Arctic shipping route is linked to melting Arctic ice? (name the route)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from the Suez Canal, which canal could new Arctic routes help ships bypass? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term does China use to label itself in relation to the Arctic? (three words, hyphen allowed)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the abbreviation of the strategic gap named after Greenland, Iceland and the United Kingdom? (abbreviation only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What was Pituffik Space Base formerly known as? (two words)

Answer: _____

Membership and Gaza governance bodies

Membership of the Board of Peace follows a set of rules. A country that joins must consent to be bound by the Board's charter, which makes the obligation binding rather than optional.

Membership is offered in two forms, one based on rotation and one based on a reported contribution. Alongside the Board, Gaza is to be run through several linked bodies. A National Committee for the Administration of Gaza is responsible for day-to-day civil administration and is made up of Palestinian figures chosen for their political independence. A separate International Stabilization Force handles security and helps train police. A High Representative acts as the link between the Board and the Gaza committee on the ground. A Gaza Executive Board, described as a supporting operational body, coordinates activities on the ground. Each of these bodies has a specific job, and together they are designed to connect international oversight with administration on the ground. The arrangement is meant to support Gaza's transition from conflict to reconstruction. The Board is led from the top, with the United States playing a central role in its formation. The rules on the Board's membership and finances are set out in its charter, which covers dispute settlement as well. Its initial authorisation is time-limited.

Q1.

Which Bulgarian diplomat is named High Representative for Gaza? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who chairs the National Committee for the Administration of Gaza? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many members does the National Committee for the Administration of Gaza have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many countries are listed as members of the Gaza Executive Board? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the tenure of rotational membership of the Board of Peace, in years? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What reported contribution, in USD billion, gives a country permanent membership of the Board? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year does the Board's initial authorisation end? (year)

Answer: _____

India-Mauritius Recall

Mauritius occupies a strategic position in the Western Indian Ocean, and India has steadily deepened its partnership with the island nation. The relationship spans security, trade and culture. On the security side, India has helped Mauritius strengthen its maritime capabilities, including coastal radar stations and integration into an Indian Ocean information-sharing network. Mauritius also takes part in naval drills led by India and is a member of the Colombo Security Conclave with India and other Indian Ocean neighbours. Economic ties are equally important. Mauritius serves as a gateway for Indian trade and investment into Africa, given its membership of the African Continental Free Trade Area. A bilateral economic agreement between the two countries has encouraged closer commercial links, and Mauritius is a major source of investment into India. Culturally, the relationship is reflected in institutions such as the Mahatma Gandhi Institute and the Indira Gandhi Centre for Indian Culture on the island. Together, these areas show how India uses partnerships in the Indian Ocean to support its wider regional interests.

Q1.

In which year were diplomatic relations between India and Mauritius established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Mahatma Gandhi visit Mauritius?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Indira Gandhi Centre for Indian Culture established in Mauritius?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Mauritius was the second largest source of FDI into India in FY 2024-25, after which country?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was the bilateral trade between India and Mauritius in FY 2024-25 (in USD million)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

India upgraded the airstrip of which island into a full-length airfield?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Comprehensive Economic Cooperation and Partnership Agreement signed between India and Mauritius?

Answer: _____

Yemen's divide and Houthi rise: short answers

Yemen has long been divided between its northern and southern regions, which differ in religious traditions, social structures and systems of governance. Foreign influence and colonial legacies reinforced these differences. Yemen lies in the south-western Arabian Peninsula, bordering Saudi Arabia and Oman, and it is flanked by the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden. Its location gives it strategic importance for shipping. During the Cold War, Yemen existed as two separate states. The Yemeni Arab Republic in the north received support from the United States and Saudi Arabia, while the People's Democratic Republic of Yemen in the south was backed by the Soviet Union. The two states later merged to form a single republic, but power remained heavily centralised, creating resentment in the south. Southern leaders attempted secession, leading to a brief civil conflict. Southern discontent later returned through a movement demanding greater autonomy or independence for the south. In the north, the Houthi movement grew out of the Zaydi Shia population. Its insurgency began after its founder was killed by Yemeni forces. Later, the movement seized large parts of the country, including the capital. Today the Houthis control the north and west, the Southern Transitional Council holds much of the south and east, and the internationally recognised government controls only limited areas in the north. The country's divisions therefore continue to shape its politics and its prospects for peace.

Q1.

In which year did the two Yemeni states merge to form the Republic of Yemen? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Southern leaders attempt secession, leading to a brief civil conflict? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Southern Movement (Al-Hirak) formed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who was the founder of the Houthi movement, killed by Yemeni forces in Saada in 2004? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the Houthis capture Sanaa, forcing President Hadi to flee abroad the following year? (year of capture)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In 2015, the Houthis expanded their control in western Yemen to include which strait? (name of strait)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Yemeni leader did the Houthis kill in 2017 for switching allegiance to the Saudi-led coalition? (full name)

Answer: _____

Awards and Honours Recall

India's civilian honours include the Padma awards, which are announced every year on the eve of Republic Day. They recognise achievements in all fields involving public service and come in three categories: Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan and Padma Shri, listed in descending order of rank. The Bharat Ratna is described as India's highest civilian award. Gallantry awards recognise

bravery shown by members of the armed forces, and they are kept in separate wartime and peacetime categories. Wartime Gallantry awards were instituted on 26 January 1950, while peacetime awards came later. Gallantry awards are announced twice a year, on Republic Day and Independence Day. Eligibility covers officers of all ranks in the Army, Navy and Air Force, reserve forces, the Territorial Army, and personnel providing nursing services under these forces. The order of precedence places the Param Vir Chakra first, followed by the Ashoka Chakra, Mahavir Chakra, Kirti Chakra, Vir Chakra and Shaurya Chakra. Gallantry awards are given for acts of bravery, while the Padma awards are given for service and achievement in public life. Each year the honours list covers a broad range of fields, and understanding the rank order of these awards helps in answering questions on both civilian and military honours.

Q1.

In which year was the Peacetime Gallantry Award instituted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many Padma Vibhushan awards were announced for 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many armed forces personnel were conferred Gallantry Awards in 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which gallantry award is India's highest peacetime gallantry award?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian, the first Indian on the ISS, was honoured with the Ashok Chakra?

Answer: _____

Q6.

From which year has 26 November been observed as Constitution Day? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which European Commission president was among the Chief Guests for Republic Day 2026? (full name)

Answer: _____

Caste Discrimination and Safeguards

Caste-based discrimination in higher education has drawn sustained national attention. Figures reported by the University Grants Commission show that complaints of caste discrimination rose sharply in recent years, and the number of pending cases also grew, even though disposal rates stayed high. Two high-profile cases have highlighted allegations of institutional caste exclusion across the country. Such discrimination is seen to erode equality, dignity and fraternity, and to undermine trust in democratic institutions. Caste bias and poor schooling limit access to elite institutions for SC, ST and OBC students, which hinders social mobility. Marginalised communities also face higher dropout rates because of academic, financial and psychological pressures, while reserved category stigma can produce anxiety, low self-esteem and poor academic outcomes. Support structures are not always effective either, since SC/ST cells in universities often lack autonomy and enforcement, weakening grievance redressal. The constitutional framework responds to these problems. Article 14 guarantees equality before law, Article 15 prohibits discrimination and permits affirmative action, and Article 17 abolishes untouchability. Several

statutes add enforcement, including the Protection of Civil Rights Act, which imposes penalties for practising untouchability, the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, which sets strict punishments, and the Right to Education Act, which promotes non-discriminatory access to education. Together, these measures combine constitutional principles with statutory penalties and guarantees of access to education.

Q1.

By what percentage did UGC-reported caste-discrimination complaints rise between 2019-20 and 2023-24? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many caste-discrimination cases were pending at UGC in 2023-24?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many caste-discrimination complaints were received in 2019-20?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the Rohith Vemula case occur?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Article of the Constitution directs the promotion of educational and economic interests of weaker sections? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Protection of Civil Rights Act enacted?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act enacted?

Answer: _____

Funding Schemes Recall

Access to finance is a central concern for new businesses, and the government has created several instruments to address it. Some instruments support the early steps of a venture, such as testing an idea, building a prototype or entering a market. Others help a recognised startup obtain loans by offering a guarantee to the lender. A larger instrument works through a corpus that supports new companies. Such instruments are managed by the department that promotes industry and internal trade under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry. Government instruments of this kind are designed to reach firms at different points of their growth. Students should note the timeline of each measure, the amount it commits and the kind of startup it reaches. Precise recall of names, dates and figures matters, because two similar schemes can be confused in examinations. Each scheme must be read against its own purpose, since support for early activities differs from a guarantee on loans.

Q1.

In which month and year was the Fund of Funds for Startups introduced?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the corpus of the Fund of Funds for Startups, in crore? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

On which date is National Startup Day observed? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which scheme provides financial assistance for proof of concept and prototype development? (scheme name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Through which type of eligible institutions is seed fund assistance channelled? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Fund of Funds for Startups aims to enhance access to which kind of capital? (two words)

Answer: _____

Tariffs and Market Access: Quick Recall

The India-EU free trade agreement is built around the reduction of customs duties on goods that move between the two economies. The European Union is already one of India's largest trading partners, so the changes affect a large volume of commerce. Under the agreement, duties on most bilateral trade are being removed, giving Indian exporters better access to European markets while giving European producers access to Indian markets over time.

The benefits are not spread evenly across sectors. Labour-intensive industries in India, including textiles, apparel, leather and footwear, are expected to gain from lower entry barriers into Europe. Some products are treated more carefully. High-value items such as luxury cars and premium wines are not opened immediately; instead, their tariffs fall in stages, and quotas limit how many vehicles can enter at the lower rate each year. India also keeps some farm products outside the tariff cuts to protect rural livelihoods.

Machinery, chemicals and pharmaceuticals are among the categories whose import duties into India will be phased out, so European exporters will benefit. The agreement remains subject to ratification by the Indian Parliament and European bodies, so its full effect will depend on how commitments are implemented. Both sides present the deal as a way to diversify trade partnerships in an uncertain global environment.

Q1.

What percentage of EU customs duties on Indian exports will be eliminated under the FTA? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

After five years, what will be the import tariff on luxury cars priced above EUR 15,000? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the annual tariff rate quota for luxury cars, in number of units?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the maximum current Indian tariff on machinery that will be phased out? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Approximately how much will EU exporters save annually from India's tariff phase-out? (in EUR billion)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from Darjeeling Tea, name the iconic product whose geographical indication is protected under the parallel GI agreement.

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was India-EU ties upgraded to a Strategic Partnership at The Hague Summit? (year)

Answer: _____

Global and Indian Fertility Context

Fertility trends are now a global concern, not only a feature of developed economies. The United Nations Population Fund publishes its State of World Population report, which tracks population data across countries. Fertility rates vary widely: some countries record very high levels, while economies such as South Korea, Hong Kong and Singapore record some of the lowest. Ageing is also a global trend, and the elderly share of the population is high in Japan and Europe. India's fertility has fallen below replacement level, but regional differences remain, with some states above replacement and others, such as Kerala and Tamil Nadu, below it. Figures cited for India show that financial stress is the main reason given for having fewer children, followed by housing and job concerns. Schemes such as the National Population Policy 2000 set the goal of replacement-level fertility and focus on voluntary choice and access to contraception. India's national policies also promote birth spacing, contraceptive use and institutional deliveries. A proposal to raise the legal age of marriage for girls aims to reduce early childbearing. Together, these measures aim to balance voluntary choice with maternal and child health.

Q1.

What is the current world population according to UNFPA's State of World Population 2025 (in billion)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which year is the global TFR projected to reach the replacement level of 2.1?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was India's fertility rate in 2025?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which above-replacement state has the highest fertility rate among those listed in the booklet?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage of India's population is of working age (15-64 years) (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was UNFPA renamed as the United Nations Population Fund?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What legal age of marriage for girls does the proposal under the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006 seek (in years)?

Answer: _____

UNCLOS and ocean zones

The law of the sea rests on a simple idea: the closer a space lies to the coast, the greater a state's control over it. A state has full sovereignty over its territorial sea. Beyond that lies a zone in which the state holds the right to exploit all economic resources. Further still lie the high seas, where vessels of every nation may sail freely. The 1982 Convention on the Law of the Sea sets out the legal framework within which all activities in the oceans and seas must be carried out. It is often described as a constitution for the oceans. The Convention also created new institutions at the international level. One of these is a judicial body that settles disputes about how the Convention is interpreted. Another protects the marine environment from harmful effects of deep-seabed activities. A further body facilitates the establishment of the outer edge of the continental shelf. Continental shelf rights can extend beyond the basic zone limits, which makes the outer edge of the shelf a matter of legal importance. The Convention provides a process for determining that edge, and the bodies it created apply its rules in practice. The Convention is also supported by implementing agreements on particular issues, such as deep seabed mining and the management of fish stocks. Taken together, these rules form many layers of law that govern the oceans, and all users of the seas rely on this shared framework.

Q1.

How many parties does the 1982 UN Convention on the Law of the Sea have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many new institutions did UNCLOS create at the international level? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the breadth of the Exclusive Economic Zone? (in nautical miles)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which independent judicial body under UNCLOS handles disputes over the Convention's interpretation? (name the body)

Answer: _____

Q5.

As per the booklet (January 2026), how many countries had ratified the UN High Seas Treaty (BBNJ Agreement) when it entered into force? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many kilometres is one nautical mile? (in km)

Answer: _____

PSLV profile recall

The Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle is widely known as the workhorse of the Indian Space Research Organisation. It is a medium-lift launcher with four stages, and it has carried many national missions, including lunar and Mars missions. Its design mixes two kinds of propulsion, since some stages burn solid fuel while others use liquid propellants. Because of this mix, it became the first Indian launch vehicle to be equipped with liquid stages, a milestone for the national programme. The rocket also holds a notable record of its own, having carried a very large number of satellites on a single flight. It is able to place heavy satellites into a Sun-synchronous orbit, which suits Earth observation work. Over the years it has launched satellites for both government and commercial customers, reflecting its reliability and flexibility. The rocket's stages fire one after another, and the upper stages must deliver steady thrust for satellites to reach their planned orbit. This makes the vehicle an important tool for both national missions and international customers. Its success has made it a central part of India's launch plans, and it continues to be a core vehicle in the country's space efforts.

Q1.

How many satellites did PSLV carry on a single flight in 2017? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did PSLV achieve its first successful launch? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Name the remote sensing satellite carried on PSLV's first successful launch.

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is PSLV's payload capability to a 600 km Sun-synchronous orbit? (in kg)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which engine powers the liquid second stage of PSLV? (name of the engine)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which PSLV launch, designated PSLV-Cxx, carried Aditya-L1 on 2 September 2023? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was Chandrayaan-1, a PSLV-launched lunar probe, launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Anti-doping and performance recall

Anti-doping rules in sport combine national law with international standards. A national agency under the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports monitors doping control programmes across the country. India's standalone anti-doping law is designed to comply with the code of the World Anti-Doping Agency and gives authorities powers for search, seizure and disciplinary action. An international convention adopted by UNESCO urges nations to enact laws that eliminate drug use in sport, and it has been accepted by many countries, including India. When disagreements arise in the sports world, they can be taken to a specialised body that offers a fair and quick way to resolve them. Sport in India is also supported by government initiatives. The Fit India Movement encourages mass participation in fitness activities, while Khelo India identifies and develops athletes at grassroots and elite levels. The National Olympic Committee is the sole governing body for Olympic sports in India. Indian athletes won several medals at the Paris Olympics and

Paralympics, and young players have also made headlines in chess and shooting. Talent identification programmes aimed at school children are meant to find promising players in every corner of India.

Q1.

In which year was the Court of Arbitration for Sport set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who is the President of the Indian Olympic Association? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many medals did India win at the Paris Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What position did India secure in the Paris Olympics medals tally? (rank)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many countries, including India, are recorded under the UNESCO International Convention against Doping in Sport? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Fit India Movement launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Indian chess player became the world's youngest chess champion at 18? (surname or name)

Answer: _____

Economy and Rankings Check

India has climbed several global economic rankings in recent years. It overtook Japan to become the fourth-largest economy measured by nominal GDP, and it is projected to move ahead of another major economy to take third place. Its growth is described as the fastest among major economies, supported by strong domestic demand and a services-led model. Services form the largest share of the economy, followed by industry and agriculture. Food prices also entered a phase of deflation, meaning a sustained fall in the general price level. The Reserve Bank of India reported that states' consolidated fiscal deficit rose to 3.3 per cent of GDP in 2024-25. Rankings also measure other aspects of national standing. The Henley Passport Index ranks passports by the number of destinations that holders can reach without a prior visa, whether visa-free or on arrival. It was first launched in 2006 and is published by a London-based firm. NITI Aayog's Export Preparedness Index, now in its fourth edition, assesses how ready Indian states and union territories are to export. It is organised around four pillars: export infrastructure, business ecosystem, policy and governance, and export performance. The index supports India's goal of reaching one trillion dollars in merchandise exports by 2030.

Q1.

What percentage weight does the business ecosystem pillar carry in NITI Aayog's Export Preparedness Index? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Singapore tops the Henley Passport Index 2026; how many countries does its passport give access to without a prior visa? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country tied with Japan for second place in the Henley Passport Index 2026?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Food prices entered deflation for the first time since which year?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year is India projected to surpass Germany to become the third-largest economy? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is India's rank in per capita nominal GDP? (rank number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which large state is named first in the 'Leaders' category of the Export Preparedness Index?

Answer: _____